not to try to make interest through others, and I give you my word I will not oppose him."

H. E. Mr Murray[134] has we believe arrived at Kirmanshah and so may be expected here in some twenty days or so, he has come by Busora and Baghdad and it is said travels in great state requiring some two hundred baggage cattle. Of the French Minister we know nothing except that he has quitted France and is on his way. It is thought that both ministers will endeavour to urge Persia to take a decided course against Russia.

The King has ordered an army of 80,000 men to assemble at Sultania and has ordered all Govt servants to be ready to march for the camp with him within one month after the festival of the no-roze (the 21st March). This measure is interpreted differently by different people, some say it is for and some against Russia, a short time will shew.[135]

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tehran, March 14, 1855*

You will perhaps have heard that I am endeavouring to obtain leave to go to England. I have already applied for it and it has been promised me but I shall not think myself safe until my leave is announced in the Gazette which is the custom. We hope to start in about two months from this time. Before that I am afraid I shall not be able to make my arrangements as to the carrying on the government Gazette etc. If I could get my arrears of pay I would engage to start in ten days but this is the great difficulty. Most Europeans on going to Europe to help them with their expenses for the journey and because they do not know well where to leave the things during their absence sell off everything and repurchase on returning. This I have found a very bad plan. They sell things for say £100 by auction and have to replace them when they return and spend £300 in doing so. We shall only sell a few things which are comparatively useless to us, and leave the rest under the care of some friend until our return; when I arrived here with the King in the autumn of '48 my whole property tents, carpets, clothes every thing included was carried on four mules, and one of them was a light load for I had a servant riding upon it. Now I suppose that thirty perhaps forty mules might be required to carry every thing we have, so much do things collect when one sets up housekeeping and remains in a place. We shall travel as lightly as possible but travelling stage by stage from here to Trebizonde, as my wife and child can not unfortunately travel post we must have several loads with us, such as bedding, carpets, tents cooking utensils etc. We shall travel as quickly as possible but I am afraid we shall not get to Trebizonde in less than two months,

134 The new British minister to Persia.

135 Nasir-i-Din finally seized upon a pretext to declare against Britain and Turkey, too late, however, to affect the fortunes of Edward Burgess.

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